

Absolutely — **battle** is a strong polysemy target because your passage uses it here:

> “In business, that is often **half the battle**.”

Here **battle** is figurative. It means **the difficult effort or struggle needed to achieve something**. The expression **half the battle** means that once an important part is done, a large part of the overall difficulty has already been overcome.

Word family: **battle / battleground / battlefield**

Base word: battle

Verb forms: battle, battles, battled, battling

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞)

Meaning in your passage: **battle = difficult struggle / effort — 奮鬥 ; 難關 ; 鬥爭**

Your sentence:

> “In business, that is often **half the battle**.”

Here **battle** means:

> **a difficult struggle or challenge that requires sustained effort to overcome.**

繁體中文 :

為了達成目標而要克服的困難、競爭或持續努力 ; 難關、奮鬥、鬥爭

Natural translation:

> “In business, that is often half the battle.”

「在做生意方面，這往往已經是**成功的一大半 / 克服了一半的難關**。」

So here:

> **battle = 為成功而要克服的困難過程**

1. **battle = fight between armed forces — 戰役 ; 戰鬥**

The core literal noun meaning.

Practice 1

> “The ****battle**** lasted for several days.”

「這場****戰役****持續了好幾天。」

Practice 2

> “Thousands of soldiers took part in the battle.”

「數千名士兵參加了這場****戰鬥****。」

****battle = 軍隊之間在特定時間、地點進行的武裝衝突****

2. ****battle = struggle between opposing people/groups — 鬥爭；對抗****

A major figurative/social meaning.

Practice 3

> “The two companies are in a fierce ****battle**** for customers.”

「兩家公司正為爭奪客戶展開激烈****競爭 / 對抗****。」

Practice 4

> “The legal battle continued for years.”

「這場法律****爭訟 / 鬥爭****持續了多年。」

****battle = 兩個對立個人、團體或利益之間的激烈對抗****

Common:

- * legal battle
- * political battle
- * battle for control
- * battle for market share

3. ****battle = difficult personal struggle — 艱苦奮鬥；長期抗爭****

A major personal figurative sense.

Practice 5

> “She faced a long ****battle**** with illness.”

「她與疾病進行了長期的****抗爭****。」

Practice 6

> “His battle against addiction lasted years.”

「他對抗成癮問題的****奮鬥****持續了多年。」

****battle = 個人為克服疾病、困難、習慣或逆境所作的持續努力****

4. ****battle = difficult effort to achieve something — 難關；奮鬥過程****

This is closest to your source.

Practice 7 — Original

> “Doing simple things extremely well is often ****half the battle****.”

「把簡單事情做到極致，往往已經是****成功的一大半****。」

Practice 8

> “Getting customers to return is a major part of the battle.”

「讓客戶再次光顧，是整個****奮鬥過程 / 難關****中的重要一部分。」

****battle = 為達成某個實際目標而必須克服的困難****

5. ****half the battle = 已完成最重要 / 最困難的一大部分****

A very high-value fixed expression.

Practice 9

> “Knowing what customers want is ****half the battle****.”

「知道客戶想要甚麼，已經是****成功的一大半****。」

Practice 10

> “Starting early is half the battle.”

「提早開始，已經是**解決問題的一大半**。」

half the battle = 一旦處理好一個關鍵部分，就已經克服了整體困難中的很大一部分

This is figurative and very common.

6. **battle = competition for something — 爭奪；競爭**

A common business/sports/media use.

Practice 11

> “There is a fierce **battle** for market share.”

「市場份額的**爭奪**非常激烈。」

Practice 12

> “The teams are locked in a battle for first place.”

「各隊正在為第一名展開激烈**競爭**。」

battle for + noun = 為取得某個位置、資源、權力或優勢而激烈競爭

7. **battle = verb, fight physically or militarily — 戰鬥；作戰**

Practice 13

> “The soldiers **battled** through the night.”

「士兵整夜**作戰**。」

Practice 14

> “The two sides battled for control of the area.”

「雙方為爭奪該區控制權而**交戰**。」

****battle — verb = 與敵方進行激烈戰鬥或對抗****

8. ****battle = verb, struggle against difficulty — 奮力對抗；與……鬥爭****

A major figurative verb sense.

Practice 15

> “Small businesses often ****battle**** rising costs.”

「小企業經常要****對抗 / 應付****不斷上升的成本。」

Practice 16

> “She **battled** stress for months.”

「她幾個月來一直****對抗壓力****。」

****battle + problem = 持續而艱苦地對抗困難、疾病或不利情況****

9. ****battle for + goal = 爭取；奮力取得****

Practice 17

> “The bakery is ****battling for**** a larger share of the local market.”

「這間麵包店正****奮力爭取****更大的本地市場份額。」

Practice 18

> “The team **battled** for every point.”

「球隊為每一分都****奮力爭取****。」

****battle for = 努力與其他人競爭以取得某個目標****

10. ****battle against / with + problem = 與……抗爭****

Practice 19

> “The company is ****battling against**** rising rent.”

「公司正****對抗****不斷上升的租金。」

Practice 20

> “He has been battling with the problem for months.”

「他幾個月來一直在****與這個問題搏鬥 / 周旋****。」

****battle against/with = 與一個困難、疾病、問題或對手持續抗爭****

11. ****battle of wills = 意志較量 ; 意志之戰****

A common figurative expression.

Practice 21

> “The negotiation became a ****battle of wills****.”

「談判變成了一場****意志較量****。」

Practice 22

> “It was a battle of wills between the manager and the supplier.”

「經理和供應商之間展開了一場****意志之戰****。」

****battle of wills = 雙方都不願讓步，看誰先退讓的心理 / 意志對抗****

12. ****uphill battle = 艱苦的鬥爭 ; 極難完成的事****

A very common figurative compound.

Practice 23

> “Competing with large chains can be an ****uphill battle****.”

「與大型連鎖店競爭可能是一場****艱苦的奮戰****。」

Practice 24

> “Changing public opinion is often an uphill battle.”

「改變公眾看法往往是一件**非常艱難的事**。」

****uphill battle = 因條件不利而極難成功的努力****

13. ****losing battle = 勝算很低 / 注定失敗的鬥爭****

Practice 25

> “Trying to keep every customer happy can be a ****losing battle****.”

「想令每位客戶都滿意，可能是一場**很難打贏的仗**。」

Practice 26

> “They were fighting a losing battle against rising costs.”

「他們在對抗上升成本時，似乎正打一場**勝算很低的仗**。」

****losing battle = 幾乎不可能成功或形勢持續惡化的努力****

14. ****battlefield = 戰場；比喻競爭場域****

A useful family extension.

Practice 27

> “The town became a ****battlefield****.”

「這座城鎮變成了**戰場**。」

Practice 28

> “Price has become the main battlefield for local businesses.”

「價格已成為本地企業競爭的主要**戰場**。」

****battlefield = literal 戰場；figuratively 激烈競爭發生的領域****

15. ****battleground = 爭奪焦點；爭議戰場****

Practice 29

> “The neighbourhood has become a commercial ****battleground****.”

「這個社區已成為商業競爭的****戰場****。」

Practice 30

> “Social media is now a major battleground for brands.”

「社交媒體現在是品牌競爭的重要****戰場****。」

****battleground = 各方激烈爭奪、競爭或爭論的領域****

Important distinction: ****battle vs war****

****war****

= broader, sustained armed conflict involving many battles.

****battle****

= one specific fight within a war, or one concentrated struggle.

> war

> = 戰爭

> battle

> = 戰役 / 戰鬥

So:

> a war contains many battles.

Important distinction: ****battle vs fight****

****fight****

very broad:

physical, verbal, personal, competitive.

battle

usually sounds more serious, sustained, difficult, or large-scale.

> fight with a friend

> = 和朋友吵架 / 打架

> battle against illness

> = 與疾病長期抗爭

Battle often carries more intensity and duration.

Important distinction: **battle** vs **struggle**

struggle

focuses on difficulty and effort.

battle

adds stronger imagery of active opposition/conflict.

> struggle with costs

> = 艱難應付成本

> battle rising costs

> = 積極、艱苦地對抗成本上升

Important distinction: **battle** vs **competition**

competition

neutral:

rivalry to win customers, prizes, etc.

battle

more intense/metaphorical:

suggests strong conflict and determined effort.

> business competition

> = 商業競爭

> battle for customers

> = 激烈爭奪客戶

Important distinction: ****battle vs challenge****

****challenge****

= a difficult task/problem.

****battle****

= the active struggle against that difficulty.

> rising rent is a challenge

> = 租金上升是一項挑戰

> battling rising rent

> = 正在努力對抗租金上升

Important distinction: ****battle vs campaign****

****campaign****

= organized series of actions toward a goal.

****battle****

= specific confrontation/struggle.

> marketing campaign

> = 市場推廣活動

> battle for market share

> = 市佔率爭奪戰

Important distinction: ****battle — literal vs figurative****

Literal:

> “The battle lasted two days.”

= 戰役持續兩天。

Figurative:

> “Winning customer loyalty is half the battle.”

= 贏得客戶忠誠已經是成功一大半。

Same underlying metaphor:

> conflict against an opponent → struggle against difficulty.

Important distinction: **half the battle vs half done**

half done

= literally 50% completed.

half the battle

= figuratively, a crucial part has been achieved.

It does **not** mean mathematical 50%.

> “Understanding the problem is half the battle.”

means:

> understanding it solves a major part of the difficulty.

Important distinction: **battle with vs battle against**

Both are possible.

battle against

emphasizes opposition.

> battle against rising costs

battle with

can mean struggle with a problem or person.

> battle with stress

For learners, **against** is slightly clearer when the opponent/problem is explicit.

Important distinction: **battlefield vs battleground**

battlefield

more literal:

actual place of battle, but can be figurative.

battleground

more often figurative:

area/topic where sides compete intensely.

> historical battlefield

> = 歷史戰場

> political battleground

> = 政治爭奪焦點

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

* **battle — military fight** = 戰役 / 戰鬥

* **battle — conflict between sides** = 鬥爭 / 對抗

* **battle — personal struggle** = 抗爭 / 奮鬥

* **battle — difficult effort** = 難關 / 奮戰

* **half the battle** = 已克服主要難關 / 成功的一大半

* **battle for** = 爭奪 / 爭取

* **battle — verb: fight** = 戰鬥 / 作戰

* **battle — verb: struggle** = 奮力對抗

* **battle against/with** = 與.....抗爭

* **battle of wills** = 意志較量

* **uphill battle** = 艱苦奮戰 / 極難成功的事

* **losing battle** = 勝算很低的鬥爭
* **battlefield** = 戰場 / 競爭場域
* **battleground** = 爭奪焦點 / 競爭戰場

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
battle — military	軍隊之間在特定時間、地點進行的武裝戰鬥
battle — opposing sides	兩個人、團體或利益之間持續而激烈的對抗
battle — personal struggle	為克服疾病、困難、習慣或逆境所作的艱苦努力
battle — goal/challenge	為達成目標而要克服的一連串困難 / 難關
half the battle	關鍵部分已處理好，因此已克服整體困難中的很大一部分
battle for	與其他人競爭以取得某個位置、資源或目標
battle — verb	與敵人、對手或困難持續激烈對抗
battle against/with	與某個問題、疾病、壓力或對手抗爭
battle of wills	雙方都不願讓步的意志較量
uphill battle	因條件不利而極難成功的努力
losing battle	成功機會很低、形勢持續不利的鬥爭
battlefield	實際戰場；比喻激烈競爭發生的領域
battleground	各方激烈爭奪或爭論的領域 / 焦點

For your original sentence

> “Instead, it focuses on doing simple things extremely well. In business, that is often **half the battle**.”

The exact meaning is:

half the battle = 一間小生意如果能把核心產品和基本事情長期做好，其實已經克服了經營成功中很大的一部分難題。

Natural translation:

> **「相反地，它專注把簡單的事情做到非常好。在做生意方面，這往往已經是成功的一大半。」

**

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > **battle in a war** → 戰役 / 戰鬥
- > **legal battle** → 法律爭訟
- > **battle with illness** → 與疾病抗爭
- > **battle for customers** → 爭奪客戶
- > **half the battle** → 已克服主要難關 / 成功的一大半

- > ****uphill battle**** → 艱苦的奮戰
- > ****battlefield**** → 戰場 / 競爭場域
- > ****battleground**** → 爭奪焦點